Date: 03/01/2022

Heat Illness Prevention Plan

The elements reflected with this Heat Illness Prevention guide are those contained in title 8 of the California Code of Regulations, Section 3995 and consist of the following:

A. Provision of Water
B. Access to Shade
C. Monitoring the water
D. Handling a Heat Wave
E. High Heat Procedures
F. Acclimatization
G. Emergency Procedures
H. Handling a Sick Employee
I. Training

Provision of Water:

Water is a key preventive measure to minimize the risk of heat related illnesses.

3395(c) Employees shall have access to potable drinking water meeting the requirements of Sections 1524, 3363 and 3457 as applicable. Where the supply of water is not plumbed or otherwise continuously supplied, **water shall be provided in sufficient quantity at the beginning of the work shift as to provide one quart per employee per hour for drinking for the entire shift.** As an employer we may begin the shift with smaller quantities of water as long as we have effective procedures for replenishment during the shift as needed to allow employees to drink one quart or more per hour. **The frequent drinking of water as described in (e) shall be encouraged.**

- As the employer we will provide at least 2 quarts of water per employee at the start of the shift.
- Employees with be provided with water in a portable container which will be kept in the areas we are working. Our shop has access to plumbed water at all times. Water containers will be located as close as practicable to the areas where employees are working, to encourage the frequent drinking of water. If terrain prevents the water from being placed as close as possible to the employees, bottled water or personal water containers will be made available, so that employees can have drinking water readily accessible.
- As part of the Effective Replenishment Procedures, the water level of all containers will be checked every hour by the employees and

more frequently when the temperature rises. Water containers will be refilled with cool water when the water level within a container drops below 50 percent.

- Daily, employees will be reminded of the location of the ice machines, plumbed water and of the importance of drinking water frequently. When the temperature exceeds or is expected to exceed 80 degrees Fahrenheit, brief 'tailgate' meetings will be held each morning to review with employees the importance of drinking water, the number and schedule of water and rest breaks and the signs and symptoms of heat illness. Ice is also available at the shop and will be put in containers to make sure that water is kept cool.
- Since water containers are smaller than shade structures, Employees will have access to water at all times and are in a shaded work area most of the time.
- Individual water containers are provided to employees and will be adequately identified to eliminate the possibility of drinking from a co-employee' container or bottle. Employees have their own individual drinking containers
- Every morning there will be a short tailgate meeting (in the employees' language) to remind employees about the importance of frequent consumption of water throughout the day.
- Every morning before leaving the yard, 2 five-gallon water containers with lids will be put on the vehicle. Ice is also available at the shop and will be put in igloos to make sure that water is kept cool.
- Our on-site foreman will monitor water containers every 30 minutes and our employees are encouraged to report to him low levels of water.
- Our supervisors will provide frequent reminders throughout the day to drink frequently, and more water breaks will be provided.
- Whenever the temperature equals or exceeds 95 degrees Fahrenheit or during a heat wave, pre-shift meetings before the commencement of work to encourage employees to drink plenty of water, and remind employees of their right to take a cool-down rest, when necessary, will be conducted. Additionally, the number of water breaks will be increased. Supervisors will lead by example and employees will be reminded throughout the work shift to drink water.
- The Supervisors will verify the water will be fresh, pure, and suitably cool and provided to employees free of charge. We will visually examine the water and pour some on their skin to ensure that the water is suitably cool. During hot weather, the water must
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be cooler than the ambient temperature but not so cool as to cause discomfort.

- Whenever the temperature equals or exceeds 95 degrees we will increase the number of water breaks for our employees and remind employees constantly to drink water.
- All water containers will be kept sanitary and only approved or tested water sources will be used. Employees have been trained to get water from tested water sources.

Access to Shade

Access to rest and shade or other cooling measures are important preventive steps to minimize the risk of heat related illnesses.

3395 (d) Employees suffering from heat illness or believing a preventative recovery period is needed, shall be provided access to an area with shade that is either open to the air or provided with ventilation or cooling for a period of no less than five minutes. Such access to shade shall be permitted at all times.

- Our employees will be moved into the office for a cooling off period.
- At customer locations we have access to lunchrooms and offices for use as cooling areas.
- Our vehicles are also a source of shade as long as they are running, and the air-conditioner is running/working
- The workplace has permanent shade structures above employees work areas.
- Since job sites are different, when our job site foreman arrives, he will check to find out where the shade/cooling areas are located. He will then notify the affected employees in a tailgate meeting as to those locations.
- Daily, employees will be informed of the location of the shade structures and will be encouraged to take a five-minute cool-down rest in the shade. An employee who takes a preventative cool-down rest break will be monitors and asked if he/she is experiencing symptoms of heat illness and in no case will the employee be ordered back to work until signs/symptoms of heat illness have abated.
- Enough shade structures will be available at this site, to accommodate all of the employees who are on such a break at any point in time. During meal periods there will be enough shade for all of the employees who choose to remain in the general area of work or in areas designated for recovery and rest periods.

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Monitoring the Weather:

We will check the weather for the extended forecast at www.nws.noaa.gov/, or by calling the National Weather Service at 559-584-8047, or by checking the Weather Channel TV Network to verify temperature for the next 10 days to check for high temperatures and heat waves.

Prior to each workday, the forecasted temperature and humidity for the worksite will be reviewed and will be compared against the National Weather Service Heat Index to evaluate the risk level for heat illness. Determination will be made of whether or not workers will be exposed at a temperature and humidity characterized as either “extreme caution” or “extreme danger” for heat illness. It is important to note that the temperature at which these warnings occur must be lowered as much as 15 degrees if the workers under consideration are in direct sunlight.

We will conduct our morning training reminding our employees the signs and symptoms of heat illness including preventive measures and first aid/emergency procedures.

We will have a thermometer at the jobsite to monitor for sudden increases in temperature, and to ensure that once the temperature exceeds 85 degrees Fahrenheit that shade is available and exceeds 95 degrees Fahrenheit High heat procedures will be implemented.

We will also drink water for frequently and have more rest breaks.

Handling a heat wave:

In the case of a heat wave and we are unable to cease work for the day, our jobsite foreman will provide a tailgate meeting to reinforce heat illness prevention, emergency response and review the weather forecast with them.

Our shop or job foreman will remind workers to drink water more frequently and will monitor them to make sure they do. They will also closely supervise all employees for signs of symptoms of heat illness.

We uses the buddy system everyday but on extremely hot days we will remind employees to watch out for each other and will ensure that emergency procedures are initiated when someone displays possible signs or symptoms of heat illness.

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High Heat Procedures

Our high heat procedures are additional preventative measures we will take when the temperature equals or exceeds 95 degrees Fahrenheit.

- Effective communication by voice, direct observation, mandatory buddy system, or electronic means will be maintained, so that all employees can contact a supervisor when necessary.
- Frequent communication will be maintained with employees working by themselves or a smaller group, to be on the lookout for possible symptoms of heat illness. The employee(s) will be contacted regularly and as frequently as possible throughout the day since an employee in distress may not be able to summon help on his or her own. The Supervisors will contact outside working employees by phone hourly to confirm employee is doing ok.
- Effective communication and direct observation for alertness and/or signs and symptom of heat illness will be conducted frequently. When the Supervisor is not available, a designated alternate responsible person will be assigned, to look for signs and symptoms of heat illness. If a supervisor, designated observer, or any employee reports any signs or symptoms of heat illness in any employee, the Supervisor or designated person will take immediate action commensurate with the severity of the illness (see Emergency Response Procedures).
- Employees will be reminded constantly throughout the work shift to drink plenty of water and take preventative cool-down rest break when needed.

Acclimatization:

Our employees work all year around. They acclimate as the weather changes daily by drinking water and running fans as the days warm up.

For new employees, the intensity of the work will be lessened during a two-week break-in period such as scheduling slower paced, less physically demanding work during the hot parts of the day and the heaviest work activities during the cooler parts of the day (early-morning or evening). Steps taken to lessen the intensity of the workload for new employees will be documented.

The supervisor will be extra-vigilant with new employees and stay alert to the presence of heat related symptoms

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Emergency Procedures:

Our emergency procedures in case of heat illness are as follows:

- Every employee knows exactly where they are at our permanent facility so as to give precise directions to where they are working to avoid delay of emergency medical services.
- At each job site each person will know exactly where they are not only as far as the facility location but where in the facility, they are…i.e. Northwest side of facility by guard shack off of Willow St.
- At each job site there will be a facility contact person and their phone number so they can be contacted in case of an emergency in order to expedite direction of emergency personnel when they get to the facility.
- We will notify the office at our permanent shop who will call emergency services if needed.
- When an employee shows symptoms of possible heat illness the Plant/Job Foreman will take immediate steps to keep the employee as cool as possible by moving them to the air conditioned room, if conscious, giving them little sips of water and applying cool clothes until medical help gets here.
- During a heat wave or hot temperatures workers will be reminded and encouraged to immediately report to their Plant/Job Foreman any signs or symptoms they are experiencing.
    - All employees have been trained in how to treat heat illness so as to aid the stricken employee.

Handling a Sick Employee

- When an employee displays possible signs or symptoms of heat illness, a trained first aid worker or supervisor will check the sick employees and determine whether resting in the shade and drinking cool water will suffice or if emergency service providers will need to be called. A sick worker will not be left alone, as he or she can take a turn for the worse.
- When an employee displays possible signs or symptoms of heat illness and no trained first aid worker or supervisor is available at the site, emergency service providers will be called.

- Emergency service providers will be called immediately if an employee displays signs or symptoms of heat illness (loss of consciousness, incoherent speech, convulsions, red and hot face), does not look ok or does not get better after drinking cool water and resting in the shade. While the ambulance is in route, first aid will be initiated (cool the worker: place the worker in the shade, remove excess layers of clothing, place ice pack in the armpits and groin area and fan the victim. Do not let worker leave the site, as they can get lost or die before reaching the hospital.
- If an employee does not look OK and displays signs or symptoms of severe heat illness (loss of consciousness, incoherent speech, convulsions, red and hot face.) and the worksite is located more than 20 mins away from the hospital, call emergency service providers, communicate the signs and symptoms of the victim and request Air Ambulance.

Training:

Training is critical to help reduce the risk of heat related illnesses and to assist with obtaining emergency assistance without delay.

- Supervisors will be trained:
    - Prior to being assigned to supervise other employees. Training will include this company's written procedures and the steps Supervisors will follow when employees exhibit symptoms consistent with heat illness
    - On their responsibility to provide water, shade, cool-down rests, and access to first aid as well as the employees' right toe exercise their rights under this standard without retaliation.
    - In the appropriate first aid and/or emergency responses to different types of heat illness, and in addition, that heat illness may progress quickly from mild symptoms and signs to serious and life-threatening illness.
    - On how to track the weather at the (by monitoring predicted temperature highs and periodically using a thermometer). Supervisors will be instructed on, how weather information will be used to modify work schedules, to increase number of water and rest breaks or cease work early if necessary

- Employees, new and returning, will receive training

a. on the environmental and personal risk factors
b. our procedures for complying with the requirements of this standard.
c. Importance of acclimating themselves to the heat
d. The importance of frequent consumption of small quantities of water, up to 4 cups per hour when the work environment is hot, and the employees are likely to be sweating more than usual in the performance of their duties.

a. To notify the foreman immediately if they themselves or a co-worker are exhibiting the signs/symptoms of heat illness. Also, to encourage workers to look out for each other.
b. They will be trained in the procedure for contacting emergency personnel and also the exact location so they can give clear and precise directions.

- Our safety coordinator will hand out a information sheet, in the employees language, explaining the different types of heat illness, how to recognize the signs/symptoms and how to treat it. They will go over the information to verify the employees understand it.